

Gaps and risks

European Master's & Scholarship Research · Tunisian applicant, 180-ECTS Licence in Business Intelligence · compiled 2026-08-16 · 181 programmes, 103 funding schemes

What this dataset does not know, what could still go wrong, and what to do about it. Companion to `verification_report.md` (V1's audit) and `coverage_audit.md` (V2's).

1. Unresolved profile fields

Seven fields in the brief were left `[FILL]`. No values were invented. Any eligibility test depending on one of them is recorded `UNVERIFIED`.

Field	What it would have changed
Expected graduation	Recency cliffs: Vilnius caps the post-bachelor gap at 5 years for non-EU applicants; ASE Bucharest requires graduation in 2023 or later. Both are invisible on aggregators.
Target intake	Every deadline in the calendar is anchored to an assumed autumn 2027. A 2028 target shifts the entire timeline by a year.
IELTS status	AUEB Marketing Analytics requires C2 ; EBS requires 7.0; most require 6.5. Whether these are reachable is unknown, and a retake costs a cycle.
GPA / mention	IE's Dean's Award needs $\geq 3.8/4$. Romania's scheme needs 7/10. Vilnius needs 60–70% averages. All unverifiable without the figure.
Budget ceiling	The difference between shortlisting Bremen at €0 and EBS at €33,780. Currently both are listed, which is unsatisfying but honest.
Funding posture	Decides whether Erasmus Mundus is the plan or a bonus.
Work-rights priority	Ireland's Stamp 1G (12 months, renewable to 24) is the strongest verified post-study right in the dataset. Whether that outweighs its equivalence risk is the applicant's call.

The highest-value unresolved question is not on that list. It is: **do you intend to return to Tunisia?** It decides how much weight the equivalence risk in §2 carries, and therefore whether one-year masters belong in your plan at all.

2. The structural risks

2.1 Tunisian equivalence — discretionary, not fatal

The *arrêté* of 10 October 2023, articles 8 and 9, requires two years of study after the licence. A one-year 60-ECTS master gives one. **But article 5 lets the commissions disregard the required years where the ECTS count is sufficient** — V1 confirmed this against the Arabic text after F3 missed it.

So: **51 of 181 rows carry discretionary risk, not disqualification.** All 15 Irish rows, 11 of 16 Dutch, all 7 Spanish. A 120-ECTS two-year programme avoids the question entirely, which is why the shortlist marks them.

Three further criteria from article 2 bite: - **Examinations must be in person.** Hybrid and distance programmes are exposed — this affects both International Hellenic University rows, which are hybrid. - **The programme must not be designed specifically for foreign students.** - **Institution and diploma must both be recognised in the awarding country.**

Action: written confirmation from the Direction de l'Enseignement Supérieur Privé et des Équivalences. Until then, treat one-year programmes as carrying real but unquantified risk.

2.2 Track B's entry-qualification wall

The majority of media-production masters require a prior degree in media, film or fine art. This is an eligibility rule, and a videography practice does not substitute: Konstfack and Stockholm University of the Arts require a BFA; Kristiania 80 ECTS in-field; Volda 90 ECTS plus practical courses; Xamk adds two years of industry work; Le Fresnoy requires bac+5.

Exactly three routes were found that are genuinely open: SRH Berlin (portfolio, not prior degree), FilmMemory (data-analytics entry assignment), and the technology-hosted programmes at Bremen, AUTH, Leiden, EKA and ZHdK.

2.3 Esprit is private — and the Tunisian bourse may not reach you

The MESRS *bourse à l'étranger* pays €800/month in the EU plus tuition. But nomination runs through the home institution, the procedure is written around public universities, and the *bourse d'alternance* variant is **expressly limited to students of établissements universitaires publics**. Whether Esprit students can be nominated at all is unresolved.

Call DGAE before the October 2026 call.

2.4 Subject-composition prerequisites

Not total credits — specific ones. Corvinus requires 18–24 ECTS across named methodology, economics and business categories; Vilnius Digital Marketing 20 ECTS in Business/Public Management or Economics; Vilnius Strategic Management 20 ECTS in micro/macro/econometrics; EMAI 12 ECTS each of maths, programming and computing science; Tilburg JADS 15 EC of maths and statistics plus named CS courses.

Auditing your Esprit transcript against these categories is worth more than any further searching. Failures here are silent and late.

2.5 Accreditation that lapses

Four Cypriot programmes were rejected because CYQAA accreditation had expired with no renewal — while their websites looked entirely normal. **ESSEC's grade de master authorisation expires 31/08/2027**, at the assumed intake. Accreditation is a point-in-time fact, not a permanent property, and MESRS equivalence depends on it.

3. Coverage gaps — what was not searched

Confirmed absences (checked, nothing qualifies)

- **Serbia** — structurally closed. Master academic studies are 1 year / 60 ECTS on a mandatory 240-ECTS base; a 180-ECTS licence does not reach the entry floor. Confirmed independently at Singidunum and Belgrade FON.
- **Bosnia & Herzegovina** — same 4+1 structure. SSST is Buckingham-validated (UK rule).
- **Luxembourg** — no media master exists; its Data Science master has no business-analytics specialisation.
- **Monaco** — no programme in either track.
- **Finland** — no national scholarship scheme exists at all.

Genuine gaps (not searched, or searched and unresolved)

Gap	Size	What it would take
Greek ministry database	1,368 programmes	<code>studies.minedu.gov.gr/program/?programme_id=N</code> — static, numbered records giving language, ECTS, fee and delivery mode . The highest-yield unexploited source in the project.
~89 of 123 institutions unchecked for scholarships	unknown	F4 checked 34 and stopped. Unchecked skew to continental public universities and Track B art schools, where awards are smaller but competition is thinner.
Albania, North Macedonia, Montenegro	2 candidates found, neither recordable	SEEU publishes no second-cycle fee (one email). UNYT has no programme-level ASCAL decision and unresolved Greenwich exposure.
Bulgaria	effectively zero	Only Sofia's Digital Marketing MA surfaced; distance-format, Bulgarian admission rules.
Second-tier Poland, Croatia, Romania, Lithuania	unknown	Poznań, Wrocław, Cracow UE, AGH, SWPS; Zagreb FEB, ZSEM; UNATC; KTU, VDU.
Portugal outside Lusófona	unknown	ISEG, U.Porto, Aveiro, IPCA, ESAD, ESTC not reached.

Schema gap

Delivery mode has no column. The brief's schema predates the discovery that MESRS requires in-person examinations, which makes hybrid and distance delivery an eligibility fact rather than a preference. It is recorded in `fit_notes` where known, but it is not queryable, and the Greek register publishes it for every programme.

4. What the audit did not verify

V1 was explicit, and this is the honest boundary of the dataset's reliability:

- **No deadline was independently verified.** Not one of 181 programme rows or 103 funding rows had its deadline re-confirmed against the source.
- **deadline_relative_to is unaudited across all 103 scholarship rows** — and it is the field most likely to cost an opportunity, because several scholarships close before the application they depend on.
- **The EU-vs-non-EU trap was not tested systematically.** The brief calls it the most common error in this task. V1 names this as the highest-value next audit.
- Level integrity **was** checked on all 181 rows: **0 violations**.
- All 392 URLs were reachability-tested: **no dead links**. V1 initially reported two 404s, re-tested with browser headers, found all 27 non-200s were false positives, and reported that rather than a phantom list.

Field completeness, stated plainly: tuition 88%, deadlines 63%, min_prior_ects 53%, post_study_work_visa 49%, living costs **11%**. Those numbers are low because agents recorded **NOT_FOUND** instead of estimating. A denser-looking dataset would have been a less honest one.

5. The six things to do first

1. **Write to the Direction de l'Enseignement Supérieur Privé et des Équivalences** and ask whether a 60-ECTS one-year master on a 3-year licence satisfies articles 8/9. Decides 51 rows.
2. **Call DGAE** and ask whether Esprit students can be nominated for the *bourse à l'étranger*. Decides whether the main Tunisian funding route exists for you.
3. **Audit your transcript** against the ECTS categories in §2.4.
4. **Book IELTS**. 4–8 weeks to a usable score; everything downstream waits on it.
5. **Start a Track B portfolio** if Track B is real for you — 2–4 months, and SRH Berlin is the one portfolio-admitted route found.
6. **Diarise November 2026 – January 2027**. Erasmus Mundus consortium deadlines, the MESRS bourse results, and Campus France all land in that window, roughly eight months before an autumn 2027 start.